Dean E. Phillips

Full-stack development lead bringing agentic AI to how teams ship

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SUMMARY

I'm a developer and team lead with 20 years of production software in .NET, Java, and Angular, across defense, payroll, mortgage, energy, and banking. I've led teams of three to 25 engineers, broken monoliths into microservices, and moved CI/CD pipelines to DevSecOps. Since 2025 I've been bringing agentic AI into delivery: first for development teams at work, and now through a multi-agent pipeline that builds, tests, and ships my own iPhone and Android app.

SKILLS

AI and agentic	Claude Code, Codex, multi-agent orchestration, MCP, custom skills and plugins, BMAD, LangChain, OpenAI API, GitHub Copilot, prompt engineering
Languages	C#, ASP.NET, .NET Core, Java, Spring, Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node, Angular, Vue, jQuery, HTML, CSS
Architecture	Microservices, REST, RabbitMQ, CQRS, Domain-Driven Design, Clean Architecture, microfrontends, Backend-for-Frontend, threat modeling
Cloud and DevOps	Azure, Azure DevOps, GitHub Actions, Docker, CI/CD, SonarQube, OWASP Dependency-Check, Trivy, Semgrep, GitHub rulesets, Git, NPM
Data and testing	SQL, Dapper, NHibernate, Hibernate/JPA, unit and integration testing, Playwright, Cypress, BDD with Gherkin

PROJECT

RepBunny Independent, iPhone and Android app 2026 - Present

- **Shipped a mobile app with an AI-first workflow:** a strength training log for iPhone and Android (Vue 3, TypeScript, Capacitor) with all data kept on the phone. Built alongside a full-time job: first commit to TestFlight in under three weeks, and live on Google Play since November 2026.
- **Designed a multi-agent delivery pipeline on Claude Code:** a GitHub Actions dispatcher starts cloud agent lanes that each take the highest-value issue from a scored backlog, build it, and open a pull request. An adversarial review agent merges it, sends it back, or asks me. CI runs more than 600 end-to-end Playwright tests on every code pull request, and the agents decide when a change is risky enough to run them first.
- **Took the code public, kept the backlog private:** a new public repo (PolyForm Shield license) with no history, so nothing private carried over. The backlog stays private, so no outsider can write text an agent acts on.
- **Governed the agents with enforcement, not instructions:** GitHub rulesets require pull requests with no bypass, code owners approve edits to the agents' guardrails, and Builder and Reviewer bots act under separate identities. CI runs secret scanning, static analysis, a dependency audit, and a workflow linter that found five real problems on day one. A threat model maps 14 threats to the OWASP LLM Top 10, each defense marked enforced or only instructed, and tracing the support email path by hand found a real gap.
- **Extended agents past the code:** monthly product, UX, accessibility, and security reviews that file scored issues; support email triage with replies I approve; App Store screenshots; and narrated sprint review videos.
- **Automated releases:** signed iPhone builds go to TestFlight from the cloud with no Mac involved, and Android builds ship nightly. Its reusable Claude Code plugins are public on my GitHub.

AI side projects since 2024: multi-agent writing pipelines (crewAI, then Claude and OpenAI structured outputs), document summarization with embeddings and FAISS, a ReAct agent experiment, and a text-to-video pipeline.

How it's built and governed, in two blog series: ai-delivery-team and ai-governance on deanphillips.dev

EXPERIENCE

Gateway First Senior IT .NET Developer 2026 - Present

- Modernizing legacy .NET applications and deploying them to the cloud.
- **Built an agentic task manager that runs my workday:** a Claude Code skill that reads my email and Teams, triages each message with me, and keeps a master task list with priorities, due dates, snoozes, and blockers by owner. It nudges me to chase requests that go quiet, summarizes projects on demand, and drafts replies for me to send. It's now how all my work comes in.

Energy World Net Software Development Lead 2025 - 2026

- **Pioneered agentic development at the company:** first lead to adopt agentic coding, building Claude Code and Codex skills and commands that captured the company's standards and ran automatically on related tasks. Packaged and demoed them so the other two development teams could adopt them, a major reason the on-the-job training initiative shipped on time.
- **Opened a new revenue opportunity with on-the-job training:** led development of an on-the-job training (OJT) module for the operator qualification platform that lets mentors review and sign off on their mentees' OJT activities. Larger clients had asked for it.
- **Led the team through BMAD adoption and expanded AI beyond engineering:** mentored the team once the company standardized on BMAD, extended AI-assisted workflows to product and QA, and wrote BMAD architecture documents on the architect's behalf.
- **Trusted with local architecture decisions:** led a team of three (two of them senior developers) and owned architecture decisions within the team's scope.

Heartland Payment Systems Solutions Architect 2022 - 2025

- **Demoed an AI payroll assistant at a company AI conference:** built a chat assistant with MCP tools modeled on the payroll API (stubbed for the demo) and read-only database queries. A user could say "update my withholdings to married" and it would ask for missing details and confirm before submitting; support staff could query payroll data and chart it.
- **Modernized front-end architecture:** led the conversion of a monolithic Angular UI into microfrontends aligned with team journeys, so teams depended on each other less and could deploy faster on their own.
- **Moved from DevOps to DevSecOps:** added SonarQube, OWASP Dependency-Check, and Trivy to CI/CD pipelines. As security champion, helped teams fix what those tools found.
- **Automated a multi-week manual process:** tax and compensation updates now run from Docker images hosted in Azure, which cut errors and kept updates on time.
- **Stabilized the payroll system:** created and ran a technical backlog that raised Net Promoter Score by 31 points and cut major incidents from double digits to zero.
- **Improved performance and integrations:** made an employee self-service app up to 90% faster by moving its data access from WCF to a Backend-for-Frontend with Dapper, and moved the FedEx integration from SOAP to REST.
- **Protected sensitive data:** oversaw a key rotation policy and the re-encryption of large volumes of sensitive data with custom-built tools to stay compliant with industry standards.

Heartland Payment Systems Senior Software Engineer 2020 - 2022

- **Worked across a large payroll codebase:** over a million lines in more than 100 repositories covering payroll, gross-to-net, tax, and compliance, keeping practices consistent across about a dozen Scrum teams.
- **Shipped payroll features:** implemented the COVID CARES Act provisions, added multi-factor authentication with Azure AD B2C, and unified multiple user logins into a single email-based login.
- **Improved architecture:** served on an architecture committee for a fragile system, and introduced microservices for shipping and billing using Clean Architecture, CQRS, and DDD. Set up many Azure DevOps pipelines.

CoreLogic (formerly Mercury Network) Senior Professional Software Engineer 2018 - 2020

- **Architected microservices:** refactored a large monolithic notification system into microservices with .NET Core and RabbitMQ, and delivered features and fixes for a public-facing ASP.NET application in two-week Scrum sprints.
- **Raised code quality:** added about 4,000 test cases across six legacy applications and services in my first year.
- **Led a winning hackathon team:** five engineers built an automatic onboarding solution in three days, taking 1st for Best New Product or Feature, 2nd for Best Technical Solution, and 3rd for Biggest Impact.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Delaware Nation Industries, Tinker AFB, Senior Java Developer and Scrum Master (2016 - 2018).** Led the rewrite of 72 ABW SC's applications from Struts 1 to Spring, Hibernate, and AngularJS, with two-factor authentication.
- **Sumaria Systems, then CSI, Tinker AFB (2012 - 2015).** .NET Developer, promoted to Senior and Scrum Master. Moved Classic ASP apps to ASP.NET.
- **Ensco Inc. (BAE Systems), Software Engineer (2005 - 2011).** Led test automation teams of up to 25 engineers for life-critical avionics software (C, Assembly, Ada, JOVIAL; DO-178B).

EDUCATION

Broome Community College Associate of Science in Computer Science, Phi Theta Kappa honor society 2009